



上海科技大学
ShanghaiTech University

www.shanghaitech.edu.cn

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Add: 393 Middle Huaxia Road, Pudong, Shanghai 201210, China

Oct. 27th, 2021

Dear Admission Officer,

I am the Vice Provost of ShanghaiTech University and Executive Dean of the School of Information Science and Technology at ShanghaiTech University, a brand-new research university in Shanghai, China, jointly established by the Shanghai Municipal Government and the Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS) in 2013. We had our first four undergraduate classes graduated in 2018, 2019, 2020 and 2021 with around 40% in each class went abroad to further their graduate education at leading institutions or universities like yours. I'd like to take this opportunity to highlight some of the recent accomplishments from our young university, as well as draw your attention to the strengths of our students.

ShanghaiTech is a young, resource-rich university with a modern residential campus in the heart of Shanghai Pudong's Zhangjiang Hi-Tech Park. With an academic focus on STEAM research, ShanghaiTech is committed to carrying out top-notch research and nurturing the next generation of innovative scientists, inventors and entrepreneurs.

With strong support from the Shanghai Municipal Government and China Academy of Science, ShanghaiTech's five schools (School of Information Science and Technology (SIST), School of Physical Science and Technology (SPST), School of Life Science and Technology (SLST), School of Entrepreneurship and Management (SEM), and School of Creativity and Arts(SCA)) and three research institutes (iHuman Institute, Shanghai Institute for Advanced Immunochemical Studies (SIAIS) and Institute of Mathematical Sciences (IMS)) , seek cutting-edge solutions to address the challenges that China and the world are facing in the fields of energy, material, environment, human health, and artificial intelligence.

Located in Shanghai's Zhangjiang Hi-Tech Park, ShanghaiTech is adjacent to some of the leading scientific and research institutions in China, including Shanghai Supercomputing Center, Shanghai Synchrotron Radiation Facility, the National Center for Protein Science, Shanghai Engineering Center for Microsatellites, and others. The area also hosts headquarters and R&D centers for many high-tech corporations such as Baidu, Huawei, Tencent, Cheetah Mobile as well as multi-nationals including IBM, Pfizer, and Astra-Zeneca.

ShanghaiTech's annual undergraduate enrollment is about 400 students, with the goal of reaching 500 students annually. About 1/2 of them choose their major in the School of Information Science and Technology. Our small scale is modeled after institutions with focused areas of excellence, e.g., my alma mater, the California Institute of Technology, with whom we have very close collaborations. Our undergraduate programs follow a principle of both breadth and depth, requiring broad scientific training through courses in engineering, physics, chemistry and biology for all undergraduates. Simultaneously, it develops core competencies in students' respective majors through an extensive array of challenging



courses, emphasizing both theoretical foundations as well as offering extensive hands-on components. We also strive to instill strong values of scientific ethics in our students, and provide them with international research and social perspectives by sending up to 50% of our undergraduates to summer or year-long academic exchanges at international universities. ShanghaiTech students who have studied at MIT, UC Berkeley, the University of Chicago and elsewhere excelled academically while abroad, and some of them achieved excellent researches under mentorship from international faculty.

The School of Information Science and Technology (SIST) at ShanghaiTech currently has 78 tenured/tenure track faculty, with a target of over 120 faculty. A number of our faculty graduated from or worked at leading institutions, including MIT, Berkeley, Caltech, UIUC and others before joining us. In addition, they have extensive engagements with these institutions, for example through mutually sponsored semester-long visits for research collaboration and training in teaching methods. For example, through our fast track program with University of Pennsylvania, 35 students of our class 2019, 2020 and 2021 were admitted to their graduate program. A total of 205 out of 569 students from our first four classes were admitted to a world top 100 university (according to the Times Higher Education Rankings) for graduate study, including 23 at a world top 10 and 75 at a world top 30 university. SIST strongly believes that it is through international perspectives as well as value for both innovation and fundamental research that our faculty can impart the highest standards of knowledge and guidance to our students.

SIST currently provides two undergraduate degree programs, in Electronic and Information Engineering, and in Computer Science. The curriculum was designed with reference to the similar ones at American universities, particularly UC Berkeley. Each academic unit in SIST courses represents 16 lecture hours and 48 hours of work outside class. Lectures and course materials are presented in English, and submission of assignments, presentations and reports in English is required. Courses emphasize both knowledge acquisition and application as well as the learning and knowledge discovery process. A variety of teaching mediums are used, including assignments and exams, written reports, oral presentations, as well as extensive project work. For example, our robotics course requires students to build wheeled robots to freely navigate unknown environments, and incorporates knowledge from electronic and mechanical design, computer vision, machine learning and other domains. Senior students also work under faculty supervision on a year-long project expected to produce novel or research-level results, and gain valuable experience honing their acquired skills as well as thorough experience with the research process.

In summary, the trainings that ShanghaiTech has provided to our students have equipped them with most broad and rigorous understandings towards science, technology, and society. Furthermore, since all our courses are taught in English, our students are proficient in communicating and writing in English. I am confident that the independence, richness and fertility of mind obtained through our trainings have prepared our students for success in their graduate studies and beyond.



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Sincerely yours,

A handwritten signature in black ink, consisting of a stylized 'Y' followed by a checkmark-like flourish.

Jingyi Yu

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Executive Dean, School of Information Science and Technology

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